using nuclear weapons, and the United States, which was not a partner in the coalition, expressed its displeasure with the operation. US president Dwight D. Eisenhower demanded that Israel immediately withdraw from the Sinai.

In the days that followed, the Israeli government held marathon discussions on all issues related to the withdrawal from Sinai and what would happen after its completion. Israel was engaging in extensive diplomatic activity with the United States, the Europeans, and various blocs in the UN. This short war created another 200,000 refugees—residents of cities and towns in northern Sinai and the Gaza Strip who fled their places of residence to Gaza and joined the 150,000 residents of the city. (There are those who claim that the number of those who fled was significantly lower and did not exceed 120,000.)

On November 25, 1956, the Israeli government announced the beginning of the IDF withdrawal from Sinai—a withdrawal of about twenty kilometers and the evacuation of two brigades (in fact, more than two brigades were evacuated, but Ben-Gurion preferred not to reveal the full extent of the retreat). At that time, a cabinet meeting was held that opened with a report by the director general of the Prime Minister's Office, Teddy Kollek, on his impressions from his visit to the United States. Kollek said that Israel, which at the time did not have any television broadcasts, could not grasp the enormous influence of American television on Israel's standing in the eyes of the American public. He spoke of the impact of "This Is Israel," a thirty- minute CBS documentary filmed in Israel in February 1956 by the legendary journalist and commentator Ed Murrow; Murrow had interviewed Ben-Gurion, Chief of Staff Dayan, Air Force Commander Ezer Weizman, and Arab refugees from the Gaza Strip, who said, "We do not like Israel, and we did not like Egypt, but we hope that Israel will make a real attempt to solve the refugee problem. Egypt has done everything it can to keep us refugees."

The diplomatic challenges facing the government were (1) the withdrawal from Sinai; (2) the future of the Gaza Strip; (3) the Suez Canal; (4) Sharm el-Sheikh and the Straits of Tiran; (5) Taba; and (6) the international force stationed at the entrance to the Gulf of Eilat.

According to Kollek, in the United States there had already been talk in favor of Israel's remaining in Gaza, not only in circles close to the administration, but within the administration itself. Kollek expressed